



ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
General Certificate of Education Advanced Level

SOCIOLOGY

PAPER 1 Structured

6043/1

NOVEMBER 2019 SESSION

2 hours 30 minutes

Additional material:
Answer paper

TIME: 2 hours 30 minutes

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the spaces provided on the answer paper/answer booklet.

Answer **four** questions only.

Question 1 is compulsory.

Answer any other **three** questions from Section B.

INFORMATION FOR CANDIDATES

All questions in this paper carry 25 marks.

You are reminded of the need for good English and clear presentation in your answers.

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Section A

Compulsory

- 1 The sociological perspective stresses the social contexts in which people live. It examines how these contexts influence people's lives. In Sociology, there are macro and micro perspectives. At the centre of the sociological perspective is the question of how groups are influenced by their society.
- (a) What is meant by the term *perspective*? [3]
- (b) Describe any **two** macro-sociological perspectives. [4]
- (c) From **one** sociological perspective you have described in part (b), how are people influenced by their society? [8]
- (d) Compare and contrast macro and micro sociological perspectives. [10]

Section B

Choose any **three** questions.

- 2 The discipline of Sociology developed in Europe in the 19th century. During that period, a number of outstanding sociologists shaped and refined the new discipline. Credit is given to enlightened thinkers and philosophers who created Sociology.
- (a) Who is a *philosopher*? [3]
- (b) Describe the contributions of any **two** founding fathers of sociology to the discipline. [4]
- (c) Explain the importance of studying sociology to the Zimbabwean society. [8]
- (d) To what extent did the enlightenment contribute to the development of sociology? [10]

3 The family is a familiar and comfortable institution. It can be heaven in a heartless world, refuge from the impersonality and stress of work or school. However, Marxists do not accept this simple and romantic view of the family.

- (a) Define the term *family*. [3]

- (b) Describe any **two** different types of families. [4]
- (c) Explain any **four** functions of the family in society. [8]
- (d) Assess the Marxist perspective of the family. [10]

4 The idea of cultural universals runs contrary in some ways to cultural relativism which is, in part, a response to ethnocentrism for example, family unit, language and taboos.

- (a) Define *cultural universals*. [3]
- (b) Describe any **two** examples of cultural universals. [4]
- (c) Explain why culture varies from society to society. [8]
- (d) 'Cultural universals serve the interests of dominant groups in society.'
Discuss. [10]

5 Sociology is concerned with a wide range of issues. What makes the views of sociologists different from views likely to be aired in a pub, at work or in other daily situations is that sociologists provide evidence to support what they say. This evidence is collected from a variety of sources through the use of social research.

- (a) What is *social research*? [3]
- (b) Describe any **two** factors that influence the choice of a research topic. [4]
- (c) Explain the stages involved in the research process. [8]
- (d) Discuss the importance of sociological research. [10]

6 The childhood stage has certain characteristics different from those of other age groups. Children experience a number of problems. A number of policies have been put in place by the Zimbabwean government to cater for children's welfare.

- (a) Define the term *childhood*. [3]
- (b) Describe any **two** characteristics of childhood. [4]

[3]

(c) Explain any **four** childhood problems in Zimbabwe.

[10]

(d) Examine government policies on children's welfare in Zimbabwe.

7

Education is a right which everyone is entitled to. The school promotes social solidarity and reduces social problems like teenage pregnancy.

[3]

(a) What is meant by the term *education*?

[4]

(b) Describe **two** ways by which education promotes social solidarity.

(c) Analyse any **four** measures taken by schools to reduce teenage pregnancy.

[8]

(d) Assess the effects of labelling on educational attainment.

[10]

The best way to understand gender is to put it within the context of gender roles. Society has stereotypes on jobs that are supposed to be performed by man and women.

(a) What do you understand by the term *gender*?

[3]

(b) Differentiate between sex and gender.

[4]

(c) Explain any **four** gender roles in your society.

[8]

(d) Discuss the influence of socialization on gender roles.

[10]

Religion exerts its political influence in many different ways.

(a) What is *religion*?

[3]

(b) Explain any **two** theories that support the concept of religion as a conservative force.

[4]

(c) Explain any **four** benefits of religion.

[8]

(d) Discuss the negative impact of religion on societies.

[10]

- 10 According to Kinsely Davis, "every society must distribute its individuals and induce them to perform the duties of their positions."
- (a) What is *social stratification*? [3]
 - (b) Explain any **two** principles by functionalists on social stratification. [4]
 - (c) Describe the importance of stratification of roles in any **two** social institutions of your choice. [8]
 - (d) To what extent is social stratification relevant to the Zimbabwean society? [10]



ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
General Certificate of Education Advanced Level

SOCIOLOGY
PAPER 2 ESSAY

6043/2

NOVEMBER 2019 SESSION

3 hours

Additional material:
Answer sheets

TIME: 3 hours

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

Write your name, Centre number and candidate number in the spaces provided on the answer paper.

Answer any **four** questions.

INFORMATION FOR CANDIDATES

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Answer any **four** essay questions.

- 1 Discuss the feminist views on discrimination and show how the Zimbabwean society uses them to address gender issues. [25] *→ race and ethnicity*
- 2 'The impact of non-work is not the same to everyone.' Discuss. [25] *labour*
- 3 Evaluate the measures taken by the Zimbabwean government to address poverty. [25] *Poverty*
- 4 With reference to Zimbabwe, explain the demographic transition theory. [25] *Population*
- 5 Analyse the impact of urbanization on culture in Zimbabwe. [25] *Urbanisation*
- 6 To what extent does globalisation have an impact on HIV and AIDS in Zimbabwe? [25] *Globalisation*
- 7 Explain any **four** types of crime in Zimbabwe. [25] *crime and Deviance*
- 8 Discuss the portrayal of women in the media. [25] *gender* *mass media*



ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
General Certificate of Education Advanced Level

SOCIOLOGY
PAPER 2

6043/2

JUNE 2020 SESSION

3 hours

Additional material:
Answer sheets

TIME: 3 hours

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

Write your name, Centre number and candidate number in the spaces provided on the answer paper.

Answer any **four** questions.

INFORMATION FOR CANDIDATES

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Answer any **four** essay questions.

- 1 "The underclass takes personal responsibility for their poverty." Discuss. [25]
- 2 Examine the impact of technological innovation on work efficiency. [25]
- 3 Analyse how school trips help learners to adjust to social situations. [25]
- 4 Discuss ways communities can deal with the effects of drought. [25]
- 5 Examine Sociological principles that the Zimbabwean government can use to address problems of urbanisation. [25]
- 6 Evaluate how globalisation benefits mankind. [25]
- 7 To what extent are people with disability catered for in the constitution of Zimbabwe? [25]
- 8 With reference to Sociological theories, examine how the public influences media content. [25]

Section A

1 Sociology and other social science subjects use similar procedures as those of natural sciences. Sociologists employ various approaches in social research like positivism and phenomenology.

- (a) Define the term *science*. [3]
- (b) Explain any **four** characteristics of science subjects. [4]
- (c) Distinguish between *positivism* and *phenomenology*. [8]
- (d) Evaluate the scientific nature of sociology. [10]

Section B

Answer any **three** questions.

2 Human behaviour might be influenced by nature or nurture. George H. Mead saw two main stages in the development of the 'self' through socialisation. Gerald Handel also noted that in the process of socialisation, children develop three key capacities.

- (a) Name Mead's **two** stages of development of the 'self'. [3]
- (b) Identify any **four** differences between nature and nurture. [4]
- (c) Explain any **three** key capacities that children develop through socialisation. [8]
- (d) "Human behaviour is the product of genetic factors". Discuss. [10]

3 In pre-modern and modern societies the family is the basic unit which carries vital functions. However, Feminists and Marxists highlight the dark side of the family where women's rights are not observed.

- (a) Define the term *family*. [3]
- (b) Describe any **two** functions of the family. [4]
- (c) Compare and contrast Radical feminists and Marxist feminists on the family. [8]
- (d) To what extent have women achieved their rights within the modern society? [10]

- 4 Cultural diversity has positive and negative effects. Cultural elements fall into two categories namely material and non-material cultures. These play a key role in shaping individual behaviour and attitudes.
- (a) Define *cultural diversity*. [3]
 - (b) Distinguish between material and non material culture. [4]
 - (c) Explain **four** ways in which the Zimbabwean culture is diverse. [8]
 - (d) Discuss the effects of cultural diversity on your society. [10]
- 5 Marxists see religion as an element which fuels oppression and also acts as a mechanism of social control.
- (a) Define *religion* from a Marxist perspective. [3]
 - (b) Describe any **two** ways religion acts as a mechanism of social control from a Marxist perspective. [4]
 - (c) Explain **four** ways by which religion violates the rights of women in Zimbabwe. [8]
 - (d) Evaluate the role of religion in society. [10]
- 6 The scientific research process takes a number of steps and sampling procedures. In collecting data, the researcher may face a number of difficulties which affect data validity and reliability.
- (a) What is *scientific research*? [3]
 - (b) Identify any **four** steps in scientific research. [4]
 - (c) Describe **three** difficulties faced by researchers when carrying out a research. [8]
 - (d) Discuss the relevance of sampling in sociological research. [10]
- 7 Educational achievement of boys and girls might be a product of factors such as gender, class and genetics. Educational inequality leads to different levels of educational attainment. However, Functionalists believe that education promotes social mobility.
- (a) What is meant by *educational inequality*? [3]
 - (b) Describe any **two** reasons for girls' educational achievements in recent years. [4]
 - (c) Examine any **three** ways in which education promotes social mobility. [8]
 - (d) To what extent is educational attainment determined by one's social class? [10]

8 A debate still exists on whether gender roles are socially or biologically constructed. In patriarchal societies, cultural practices are blamed for contributing to the spread of HIV/AIDS.

- (a) What are *gender roles*? [3]
- (b) Describe any **two** gender roles that can only be ascribed to women. [4]
- (c) Examine any **four** gender practices which contribute to the spread of HIV/AIDS. [8]
- (d) Discuss how gender roles are socially constructed. [10]

9 Marx believed that social classes are found in every society, and there are two social classes which are the bourgeoisie and the proletariat. Weber also noted that there are a number of determinants of one's position in a stratified society.

- (a) What is a *social class*? [3]
- (b) Explain **two** differences between the bourgeoisie and proletariat. [4]
- (c) Describe any **four** views by Weber on the determinants of one's position in society. [8]
- (d) Assess the relevance of social classes in Zimbabwe. [10]

10 Children are abused in various ways in society. Some communities equate the position of children to that of women.

- (a) What is *child abuse*? [3]
- (b) Explain any **two** similarities between the position of women and children in society. [4]
- (c) Describe how age difference contributes to inequality in society. [8]
- (d) Examine the Interpretivist view that age is a social construct. [10]



ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
General Certificate of Education Advanced Level

SOCIOLOGY

PAPER 2 Essays

6043/2

JUNE 2019 SESSION

3 hours

Additional material:
Answer sheets

TIME: 3 hours

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20

Answer any **four** essay questions.

- ✓ 1 Examine the effectiveness of measures to address unemployment in Zimbabwe. [25]
- ✓ 2 Distinguish between relative and absolute poverty. [25]
- ✓ 3 Discuss the challenges facing resort and recreational areas in Zimbabwe. [25]
- 4 Analyse the extent to which trade unions have become effective in Zimbabwe. [25]
- 5 To what extent is technology useful in enterprising? [25]
- 6 Explain the usefulness of methods of social control in Zimbabwe. [25]
- Assess the validity of official crime statistics in understanding of crime. [25]
- Examine the role of the mass media in promoting deviance in Zimbabwe. [25]

→ Crime in Zimbabwe

→ Crime statistics

Section A
(Compulsory)

- 1 Sociology as a scientific discipline, seeks to develop ways of studying the social world. A variety of factors contributed to the development of sociology as a discipline. Auguste Comte, coined the term sociology and suggested that society passed through three stages...
- (a) Define the term *sociology*. [3]
 - (b) Identify any **four** factors that led to the development of sociology as a discipline. [4]
 - (c) Illustrate Auguste Comte's three stages of societal development. [8]
 - (d) Assess the role played by the industrial revolution in the development of sociology. [10]

Section B

Choose any **three** questions.

- 2 Children who are inadequately socialised are unable to fit into society. Wild children lack socialisation and bear little resemblance to society. Therefore, socialization plays a key role in influencing human behavior.
- (a) What is meant by *inadequate socialisation*? [3]
 - (b) Describe any **one** case study which shows the effects of lack of socialisation. [4]
 - (c) Examine any **four** characteristics of individuals who lack socialisation. [8]
 - (d) Justify the importance of socialisation in shaping individual behaviour. [10]
- 3 Single-parent households have become increasingly common in modern society. The figures however, must be interpreted with caution because they are only a snapshot, and do not represent the dynamic nature of many families.
- (a) What is a *single-parent household*? [3]

- (b) Describe **two** causes of single parenthood. [4]
- (c) Explain any **four** challenges of single parenthood. [8]
- (d) Examine survival strategies that single parents can employ to overcome the challenges they are facing. [10]

4 Culture is closely connected to society. It refers to shared symbols and their meanings prevailing in any society or part of society. Culture consists of all human made products associated with a society. Two types of cultural products that exist in society are material and non material culture.

- (a) Identify any **three** components of *material culture*. [3]
- (b) Describe any **two** components of non-material culture. [4]
- (c) Explain any **four** ways of conflict resolution by your community. [8]
- (d) Examine the functionalist perspective on culture. [10]

5 Social factors influence the type of religious organisations that are created, especially on who joins and develops them. Some become churches while others are known as denominations.

- (a) Define the term *religion*. [3]
- (b) Distinguish between a church and a denomination. [4]
- (c) Explain any **four** characteristics of a church. [8]
- (d) Examine the influence of Christian denominations on believers in Zimbabwe. [10]

6 Ethical issues are also a factor that has to be considered when doing research. Social science researchers have a duty of caring for their research group to ensure their safety.

- (a) What is meant by *ethics* in research? [3]
- (b) Outline any **four** examples of ethical considerations in research. [4]

- (c) Discuss the importance of ethics in social research. [8]
- (d) To what extent does the interpretivist method observe ethical issues? [10]

7 Labelling of pupils might not be that important, although many sociologists claim that it has important effects upon the progress of pupils. Teachers' labels can affect pupils' progress in a number of direct and indirect ways.

- (a) Define the term *labelling*. [3]
- (b) Describe any **two** causes of labelling. [4]
- (c) Explain any **two** effects of labelling on learner performance. [8]
- (d) Examine the labelling theory in education. [10]

8 Some people engage in impression management, where they make an effort to present themselves to others in ways that are most favourable to their own interests. Social interaction like a theatre, has a front stage and a back stage.

- (a) Define *symbolic interaction*. [3]
- (b) Describe the differences between the back and front stages of social interaction. [4]
- (c) Explain any other **two** interactionist theories of socialization. [8]
- (d) How relevant is Geffman's theory in explaining everyday life? [10]

9 Youth culture differs from the culture of older generations. Within youth culture, there are many distinct and constantly changing youth sub-cultures.

- (a) Define the term *generation*. [3]
- (b) Describe any **two** problems facing youths in Zimbabwe. [4]
- (c) Explain any **four** measures the youths are taking to solve problems they are facing. [8]
- (d) To what extent have the youths succeeded in solving those problems? [10]

10

The Marxist perspective of social stratification identifies two social classes. Weber and Marx have contrasting views on social stratification. Functionalists argue that social stratification is a functional aspect of society.

- (a) Identify Marx's **two** social classes. [2]
- (b) Describe any **two** ideas of Marxism on social stratification. [4]
- (c) Compare and contrast Weber and Marx's views on social stratification. [8]
- (d) "Social stratification is a functional aspect of society". Discuss. [11]